

Daniel Smith

Software Engineer — AI Systems, Platform & Reliability

Pacifica, CA (San Francisco Bay Area)

daniel@danielsmith.io | danielsmith.io | github.com/futuroptimist | linkedin.com/in/danielsmith4483

Summary

Software engineer with 12+ years building production systems, including nearly seven years at YouTube. Ships AI products end to end—from TypeScript/Svelte interfaces and Python/Go APIs to local LLM inference—and builds the Kubernetes, delivery, observability, and incident-response systems that keep them reliable.

Experience

Independent Software Engineer — AI Products & Infrastructure

Remote

Independent Engineering

Jun 2025 — Present

- Built **token.place**, a privacy-focused distributed LLM platform with an OpenAI-compatible API, relay-blind end-to-end encryption, local inference, and failover, cancellation, and recovery paths.
- Implemented Tauri desktop compute-node work for **token.place** on Windows CUDA and macOS Metal targets, with deterministic long-context validation through the 64K tier.
- Designed and operated **Sugarkube**, a reusable multi-node Raspberry Pi k3s/Helm platform deploying **DSPACE**, **token.place**, and **danielsmith.io** through immutable OCI releases, health gates, promotion, rollback, and recovery.
- Shipped **DSPACE** and **danielsmith.io** using Astro/Svelte/TypeScript products and APIs with browser testing, offline and SSR safeguards, privacy and accessibility controls, and WebGL-to-text failover; operated Prometheus, Grafana, PagerDuty, and Cloudflare integrations.

YouTube (Google)

San Bruno, CA

Site Reliability Engineer

Sep 2018 – May 2025

- Owned product-health metrics and leadership dashboards for high-traffic YouTube surfaces, giving product and engineering teams a shared basis for reliability reviews and prioritization.
- Built Python, Go, SQL, and C++ automation for monitoring, anomaly analysis, and operational workflows across large-scale production systems.
- Owned on-call and incident response across Core, Trust & Safety, and Search SRE; guided teams across Alphabet and authored reusable playbooks. Mentored engineers. Promoted in 2021.

Naval Research Laboratory

Stennis Space Center, MS

Software Engineer

Jan 2017 – Sep 2018

- Built C++/Qt data-processing applications for research workflows and delivered iterative releases, demonstrations, and documentation in a distributed Scrum team.

The University of Southern Mississippi

Hattiesburg, MS

Software Developer

Mar 2014 – Dec 2016

- Built an Objective-C content-delivery and networking framework for university iOS applications, supporting real-time content updates.

Skills

Languages: Python, Go, TypeScript/JavaScript, SQL, C++, Bash

Systems & Reliability: Kubernetes, k3s, Helm, Docker/OCI, Linux, Google Cloud, GitHub Actions, distributed systems, SLOs, incident response, Prometheus, Grafana, PagerDuty, monitoring and alerting, CI/CD

Product & AI: Svelte, React, Astro, Flask, REST/OpenAI-compatible APIs, local LLM inference/model serving, Tauri, llama.cpp

Education

University of Southern Mississippi — M.S. Computer Science (2016), B.S. Computer Science (2015), GPA: 4.0